# The "Could Mom Qualify for Medicaid?" Checklist

What to gather, write down and ask before you apply.

Mom needs care now, your family is paying for it, and somebody has said the word "Medicaid." Before anyone looks at where she stands, make sure you have these in hand. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is something still to find or ask, not a sign of where Mom stands.

## Gather

- [ ] Whatever the hospital, the rehab or the facility has put in writing about the care Mom needs now.
- [ ] The papers you have that show where Mom lives and her citizenship or immigration status. [2]
- [ ] Your list of Mom's income and what she owns, with the statements behind it, as far as you've got.
- [ ] The deed to Mom's home, a current property tax bill, and any mortgage or home loan statement. [1]
- [ ] Trust documents, annuity contracts and life insurance policies, if she has any.

## Write down

- [ ] What you've been told about Medicaid so far, such as "too much money" or "spend down," and who said each thing.
- [ ] Whether Mom is married and, if she is, where her spouse is living.
- [ ] Whose name is on the home and on each account, exactly as the paperwork shows it, including anything owned with someone else.
- [ ] Any gifts, transfers or changes in ownership anyone remembers, with rough dates and who was involved. Write them as they happened, without deciding what they mean. [1]
- [ ] What you couldn't find: each missing paper, and who might have it.

## Ask

- [ ] The facility's social worker or business office: which Medicaid program in Mom's state goes with the kind of care she's getting.
- [ ] Your brothers and sisters, and anyone who has helped Mom with her finances: what they remember about gifts, transfers, or a name added to an account or a deed.
- [ ] Your Medicaid planner: what they would want to see before looking at where Mom stands.
- [ ] Your Medicaid planner: which of your open questions can be settled by finding a paper, and which belong to an elder law attorney or a licensed financial professional.

**What this checklist doesn't do**

It helps you gather, write down and ask. It doesn't say whether Mom may qualify, what any item means for her, or what to do about it, and a page full of checks isn't an answer either way. Medicaid rules vary by state, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice. Those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional, and to the next step below.

## Ready for the next step?

You know what to gather, what to write down and who to ask. The planning interview takes it from there: it asks about your family's situation, one question at a time, and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

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### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 or 2 follow what the Administration for Community Living and Medicaid.gov say a state looks at or may ask an applicant to document. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare information), Applying for Medicaid
2. Medicaid.gov (Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services), Eligibility Policy